

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Stream of Wealth'

Āryadhanadhārā nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 663 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ནོར་གཅིག་ཅེས་བརྒྱུད་པའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 663 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as "Nor gyi rgyun" and in Sanskrit as the "Dhāraṇī of the Stream of Wealth," belonging to the broader category of dhāraṇī and ritual literature within the Kangyur. The text presents both the dhāraṇī itself — a sacred formula invoking the Blessed Lady associated with wealth and abundance — and detailed ritual instructions for its practice, including specific timing, bodily purification through immersion in water, fasting, and the creation and veneration of a painted image of the deity. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts that preserves potent formulas and their associated ceremonial procedures transmitted as authentic Buddha-word. The opening lines note the joyful approval of the world and its gandharvas at the Blessed One's declaration, framing what follows as a direct teaching on the ritual application of this powerful stream-of-wealth dhāraṇī.

The world together with its gandharvas rejoiced, and they praised with approval what the Blessed One had declared. The noble dhāraṇī called "Stream of Wealth" is complete.

Then the Blessed One shall explain the ritual procedures of Dhāraṇī of the Stream of Wealth. First of all, on the first day of the bright fortnight of the last month of spring, one should go to a river that flows into the ocean, and from that point until evening one should sit submerged in the water, gazing directly toward the sun, and recite for as long as one remains there. Having abandoned all food, having sapped and silenced the afflictions, one should recite for seven nights. Then a painted image of the Blessed Lady — her body anointed with saffron and sandalwood except for her hair — should be made: rising early in the evening, it shall be an image seven cubits in height and three cubits in breadth, ten cubits altogether, fashioned with all manner of colors as a divine figure with the ritual observance of restoration, the Blessed Lady with a complexion of variegated yellow-green, adorned with all manner of ornaments; in her right hand she holds a great fruit; in her left hand she holds a precious basket set with pearls, a vajra, and vaiḍūrya fruits, to be given to practitioners. Above, divine sons are shown raining down a shower of jewels. To her right the Great Glorious One bearing a lotus stands in an attitude of care and attention toward the practitioner. To her left there is a

hand filled with a cupped handful of precious lotus splendor. Below, the practitioner holds hands formed in the lotus gesture. Then the painted image, together with a reliquary stūpa containing relics, is spread out facing westward; and thereupon, apart from the torma for daily use, one presents the treasury offerings as well and performs a great offering with fragrant flowers, and burns sandalwood and aloeswood incense. One should offer a hundred lamps of clarified butter. Then, remaining on a single seat, fixing the mind on the face of the Blessed Lady, and reciting throughout the night until dawn — at the time when dawn breaks, a stream of all precious wealth sufficient to fill the dwelling of a great man will flow and the house will become full. Alternatively, at midnight one should recite eight hundred clear recitations within the water. By performing this practice continually for one month, a stream of wealth will flow, and for some it will increase beyond knowing. Alternatively, if one desires the royal treasury, one should recite within the water by day, and at midnight perform eight hundred fire offerings with sesame seeds, and one will obtain great gain from the royal lineage. If one performs fire offerings with white mustard mixed with butter, one brings the king under one's power. If one performs fire offerings with kuṇḍuru incense, one brings the king's ministers under one's power. With whatever practice some perform, if at night one recollects the Blessed Lady enthroned upon a lotus, one will become a great patron. Furthermore, the great sādhana shall now be explained: beginning from the first day of the bright fortnight of the month of miracles, having cut off all food as completely as possible, one spreads and hangs a painted image facing westward before a stūpa containing relics, and by day one reads the Perfection of Wisdom, and at night, remaining on a single seat, one recites silently in a whisper — one will find a great heap of wealth, and even if it is scattered and damaged it will not be exhausted. One should build a great temple. If this ritual procedure is performed with recitation during the bright fortnight of the month of miracles, one will attain sovereignty as a wheel-turning king, one will actually behold the Blessed Lady Dhāraṇī of the Stream of Wealth in person, and one will become a non-returning bodhisattva. Living purely as befits this, abandoning blameworthy food, alcohol, fish, and flesh, and reciting at night, one will not become poor. Then the noble Ānanda and —

— and the noble Candraprabha (Candraprabha, "Good Moon") and —

Translator's Notes

- The passage is a ritual manual describing the practice associated with the dhāraṇī of the Stream of Wealth. Several measurements and material details involve technical ritual Tibetan terms. "Zhugsal" rendered as "clear recitations" follows the Tibetan "zhu gsal brgyad brgya," literally "eight hundred clear/lucid recitations"; the precise technical meaning in this ritual context is not fully transparent but most likely refers to audible, articulate repetitions as opposed to silent ones. The phrase "nus ma'i bar" rendered as "until evening" follows the most natural reading of the temporal phrase in context, though it could alternatively mean "until the breast" in a literal bodily sense, which would not make obvious ritual sense here; the former reading is adopted. The term "kuṇḍuru" is a plant resin incense; it is left in approximate transliteration as it appears in the Tibetan. The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text breaks off.
- The passage breaks off mid-sentence, as in the preceding excerpt. "Candraprabha" literally means "Good Moon" or "Moonlight," and the Tibetan རྩམ་ལྷ་མོ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ renders a name meaning approximately "Excellent Moon" or "Good Moon." This may be a variant form of the standard name Candraprabha; the slight difference between "good moon" and "moonlight" is noted here as a potentially consequential textual detail.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.